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Meeting Sep 27, 2026 at 18:30 CAT

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Healthcare research interview covering insurance navigation and emergency challenges and mobile application solutions

Research background and healthcare access in Rwanda

- Group 15 is conducting user empathy research regarding healthcare, insurance, and emergency access in Rwanda.
- Stephane has lived in Rwanda for 1 year and holds Britam health insurance coverage.
- Stephane noted that locating covered pharmacies requires cross-referencing insurance lists with mapping tools.
- Lengthy insurance verification paperwork and unknown emergency hotlines create obstacles during medical crises.

Mobile application concept and features

- Tony proposed a mobile application mapping nearby pharmacies and displaying insurance compatibility and operational status.
- Stephane evaluated the mobile application concept positively as a way to reduce emergency stress.
- Stephane suggested tracking pharmacy inventory stocks to confirm specific drug availability prior to visits.

Next steps

- ☐ [Tony Robert] Track Inventory: Incorporate an inventory stock tracking feature into the application.

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Full notes

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CAT

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Summary

Healthcare research interview covering insurance navigation and emergency challenges and mobile application solutions

Participant Healthcare Background

Participant shared health insurance usage and pharmacy selection methods relying on approved lists.

Emergency and Administrative Delays

Emergency preparedness lacks local hotlines and administrative delays with insurance providers cause friction.

Application Concept Evaluation

Mobile application concept integrating pharmacy matching and inventory tracking received positive evaluation.

Next steps

- ☐ [Tony Robert] Track Inventory: Incorporate an inventory stock tracking feature into the application.

Details

- **Research Objectives and Consent Process:** Tony Robert outlined the research goals for group 15, focusing on understanding user experiences regarding healthcare, pharmacies, insurance, and emergency services in Rwanda to develop a healthcare empathy application ([00:00:18](#)). Tchatchum Stephane provided formal consent to participate in their recorded interview session ([00:04:52](#)).
- **Participant Background and Pharmacy Selection Methods:** Tchatchum Stephane shared that they are from Cameroon and have lived in Rwanda for a year, maintaining generally good health and using their health insurance ([00:06:12](#)). When needing medicine, Tchatchum Stephane explained that they review the list of approved hospitals and pharmacies provided by their insurance and use Google Maps to find the closest option ([00:07:20](#)).
- **Emergency Preparedness and Healthcare Administrative Delays:** Regarding medical emergencies, Tchatchum Stephane stated they do not know the local emergency or ambulance hotlines and would rely on Google searches or asking friends or school facilitators for assistance ([00:08:43](#)). Furthermore, Tchatchum Stephane highlighted significant operational delays caused by slow paperwork and verification processes with insurance providers like Britam when accompanying a sick friend to the hospital ([00:10:17](#)).
- **Mobile Application Concept for Pharmacy and Insurance Matching:** Tony Robert introduced their mobile application concept, which aims to help users identify nearby pharmacies that accept their specific insurance and check operating statuses ([00:11:33](#)). Tchatchum Stephane evaluated the concept positively, noting that centralizing this information in an application would alleviate the stress of checking separate lists during emergencies ([00:13:12](#)).
- **Proposed Inventory Tracking Feature:** Tony Robert proposed incorporating pharmacy inventory tracking into the application, suggesting it would be beneficial to track stock availability. Tchatchum Stephane agreed with this addition, pointing out that an updated database of pharmacy drug stocks would prevent patients from traveling to a covered pharmacy only to find their specific medication unavailable ([00:14:21](#)).

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Transcript

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CAT - Transcript

00:00:18

Tony Robert: Okay. So my name is Robert Tonyi and I'm planning to launch an interview session with uh a friend of mine which we are planning to uh conduct some questioning around some questions which are um are targeting uh certain research that we want to um to conduct. So yeah, just a few minutes he'll be joining and uh yeah, that is all. to Yeah. So for background purposes we are group 15 and we are our mission sector is in healthcare and uh this is to just try to get personal and mission u empathy apps for what we are trying to do targeting every user. So in a few minutes Stephanewill be joining and uh we'll start right away.

Tchatchum Stephane: Hello Tony.

Tony Robert: Uh, hello. How are you?

Tchatchum Stephane: I'm fine, thank you. How are you?

Tony Robert: I'm fine.

Tchatchum Stephane: Do I have to on my camera?

Tony Robert: No, you don't have to. It's It's If you want.

Tchatchum Stephane: Okay. Okay.

Tony Robert: Okay. So, I'm going to record.

00:04:52

Tony Robert: Unfortunately, recording is a premium feature. I'm going to use aim. Okay. So yeah, the recording has started. Let us go right into this. I hope you're okay though.

Tchatchum Stephane: Sorry.

Tony Robert: I hope you are okay.

Tchatchum Stephane: Yeah. Yeah. Yeah. Yeah.

Tony Robert: Yeah. So thank you for taking time to speak with me. So as I had sent you a message uh we are trying to conduct our research for our final project and and we want to

Tchatchum Stephane: Yeah.

Tony Robert: understand people's real experiencing accessing health care pharmacies insuranceances and emergency services in Rwanda and

Tchatchum Stephane: Okay.

Tony Robert: uh I was like let me reach out to you and then get get to ask you some questions. Yeah.

Tchatchum Stephane: Okay.

Tony Robert: Okay. So, do I have your consent? Do you agree to participate?

Tchatchum Stephane: Yeah. Yeah. Yeah. You have my consent.

Tony Robert: All right. So, when you first arrived here, could you um tell me about your Okay.

00:06:12

Tony Robert: First, can you just tell me about yourself and your experience living and working in Rwanda?

Tchatchum Stephane: Okay, my name is Stephane. I am from Cameroon and I've been in Randa for a year now. Yes, it's been a year since I came to Randa and um Okay, my first experience was Yeah, I think all of us know that Randa is beautiful. It's a beautiful country. Yes, it's a very beautiful country. But I I I'm really I don't by God's grace I'm a healthy person. So on the health side I'm not really it's true I fall sick from time to time but it's not that deep. So it's only basic um uh things.

Tony Robert: Okay. Okay. So, you have been in Rwanda for a year, right?

Tchatchum Stephane: Yes.

Tony Robert: Damn. Okay. Say that uh you Okay. Do you have a a health insurance?

Tchatchum Stephane: Yes, I do. I I imposes a health insurance. I use Bard.

Tony Robert: Oh, okay. Okay.

00:07:20

Tony Robert: Okay. Okay. So, I was about to ask you if you have ever needed health care or medicine in Rwanda using your using your insurance card.

Tchatchum Stephane: Okay. I not really. It was not really I just I was just going for a check a full a full body check you know to check for maybe just in that that might have popped up without me noticing. So I went for a full check with the with the insurance nothing else.

Tony Robert: Okay, I understand. Okay. So, but you do have you do have the need to get medicines. I don't know.

Tchatchum Stephane: Yes, of course. I everyone does have the need to get medicine.

Tony Robert: So,

Tchatchum Stephane: Um the insurance is able to.

Tony Robert: how do you Yeah. So, how do you normally decide where to go? If maybe you need one in the pharmacy in Rwanda, in your area, I don't know. How do you decide to go about it?

Tchatchum Stephane: I usually check because our insurance give us a list of hospitals they they um they cover or pharmacies they cover and then I look I look at the list and then I look for the one that's closest to my place.

00:08:43

Tony Robert: Oh, so you use Google Maps, I presume.

Tchatchum Stephane: Yes.

Tony Robert: Okay. So, yeah, that's very helpful. It narrows down many questions to fewer because I was about to ask you how do you get to know that this particular pharmacy covers or this particular pharmacy works with your insurance and all that but yeah that is helpful and um I guess as then if if What emergency or am? Do you happen to know the uh hotlines for emergency or ambulance numbers in Rwanda?

Tchatchum Stephane: No, I don't think I know them.

Tony Robert: Oh, okay. And I guess if you wanted to to to know one, it's a Google search.

Tchatchum Stephane: Yes, obviously. Or ask a friend.

Tony Robert: Yeah. So yeah, and then what would make it easier for you to get help during a medical emergency? If it's an emergency, you don't have time to do a Google search or as in what will be better in that situation.

Tchatchum Stephane: I don't know if I had access to all the information in one place, it would have been easier.

00:10:17

Tchatchum Stephane: Or maybe if I have a random neighbor or somebody that knows all those details would help. But in case of an emergency, I really don't know what I'm going to do. I'm just going to look for a way on the spot like maybe ask a friend or call someone, call my friends or call a facilitator in school or someone but I really don't know how I'll do in the moment.

Tony Robert: Okay. Okay. So, I'm guessing that your mission might not be in healthcare. Okay.

Tchatchum Stephane: No,

Tony Robert: So I was I was about to ask uh if you could change one thing about the process even though you're not you don't mostly leave the point of view of healthcare mission and all that. If you could change one thing about the process targeting the operations of this whole thing what would you do?

Tchatchum Stephane: I believe the paperwork because I feel Because there was once I was going I was accompanying my friend to the hospital and then the paperwork was really long. We had to check verify Britam um our numbers from Britam.

00:11:33

Tchatchum Stephane: Britam had to confirm if we were able to um carry on with the processes and my friend was not feeling okay. So we had to like we had to help them like they had to ask them to be quick and they were not quick. It was very slow and then yeah it's true if they finally got she finally got the help she needed but still if the process was faster would have been

Tony Robert: Mhm. Okay. All right. So just to give you context about our application in order for you to know if maybe we are the right way or if we could do something to uh improve that we have we have discovered that um we do have means to get uh information about which pharmacy works if a certain uh insurance

Tchatchum Stephane: Mhm.

Tony Robert: whaties are near us uh as in which are open open and closed status and all that and um getting to know okay for the medicine part we haven't covered that yet and uh I wouldn't say that I wouldn't say that the the paperwork for the insurance is is um we could resolve it as well I wouldn't say that is is that our mission is to make sure that if you want to access a medicine or if you want to just go to a certain pharmacy, you know that it covers your insurance and uh this is

00:13:12

Tchatchum Stephane: Yeah.

Tony Robert: via a mobile application and uh that application

Tchatchum Stephane: Mhm.

Tony Robert: will have a way to map out where you are and the pharmacies near you and and the system will know what what

Tchatchum Stephane: Okay.

Tony Robert: insurance is or what insurers that that pharmacy accept or work with so that you don't just enter the pharmacy and they're like we don't work with your insurance and you go out and you Yeah,

Tchatchum Stephane: Yeah.

Tony Robert: it's annoying.

Tchatchum Stephane: Yeah.

Tony Robert: So

Tchatchum Stephane: I believe it's a good idea because you know there was sometimes you might be in an emergency and you need to look for you have to check the list and then you have you're checking and you stressing up. If you have all that in one place in in the form of an app, it's going to be way easier. That's a great idea.

Tony Robert: yeah. So do could you advise on a feature or a function we could add to support all that? I don't know.

Tchatchum Stephane: Um, I would say um I don't know.

00:14:21

Tchatchum Stephane: Okay, let me let me think a little.

Tony Robert: Mhm. It's okay.

Tchatchum Stephane: Um,

Tony Robert: I don't know. Maybe capturing the inventory stocks of the pharmacy. I don't know.

Tchatchum Stephane: yes,

Tony Robert: It will be

Tchatchum Stephane: exactly. we might reach the pharmacy and then they don't have the particular drug you're looking for although they are covering with the

insurance you have. So having an updated database of the different stocks of each pharmacy would be nice too.

Tony Robert: Yeah, it will be nice but not easy. But yeah, that's that that's helpful. So yeah, that was the last question and uh thank you very much for participating.

Tchatchum Stephane: Yeah, you're very welcome. Thank you so much for showing me.

Tony Robert: Yeah. So recording stopped.

Tchatchum Stephane: Okay, thank you, Tony.

Tony Robert: Yeah. I hope you uh could you just an aside thing could you give me update of what has been happening in the choir.

Tchatchum Stephane: Okay. So, we today we just finished recording our um so you know there's a health um health tech lab on Tuesday. I don't know. Then um we were asked we asked to perform but later on they decided that we we will be recorded instead. So, we produced our own music with some other people and then we we finished the recording today. They going to do the editing and stuff and then on Tuesday they're going to broadcast it with an animation. Then,

Tony Robert: Oh,

Tchatchum Stephane: yeah. And then what what else? We have also birthday celebrations coming up. It's true. Malik has not yet decided on which day we're going to celebrate, but it's next week. It's definitely going to be next week. And um

Transcription ended after 00:16:16

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